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The website I created is a travel service, the purpose is to satisfy the people who like to planning their traveling. Personally, I love traveling and always make a thorough plan for each day's itinerary and attractions before a trip. However, I noticed that there isn't a centralized, comprehensive travel guide website. Travelers often spend a lot of time searching for different information on Google. Therefore, I decided to build a platform where travelers can find all the guides and destination recommendations they need in one place.

Before coding, I researched some popular travel websites like Lonely Planet and TripAdvisor for inspiration. Next, I planned out the content and images for each page. The homepage needed to feature an image related to global travel, along with a navigation bar at the top that includes links to "Destinations," "Landscapes," "Photo Gallery," "Travel Tips," and "Contact Us." I also included a search bar on the right side, allowing users to search for cities or attractions directly. The main body is the maps of 7 continents, which can help users select the continental information they need.

The destinations page focuses on travel attractions in different continents. It provides an overview of the continent's main features, and introduces popular landscapes with images and brief descriptions. Each landscape has a link that leads to more detailed guides, making it easier for users to explore. The landscapes page offers more in-depth details about the attractions, including opening hours, transportation, ticket prices, and high-quality images. Additionally, I also created the photo gallery page that shows all the images on the website, allowing users to find destinations through visual inspiration.

When designing the website, I considered two main user personas.

Persona 1: Eric, the Young Student Traveler

- Demographics:

- Age: 22
- Marital Status: Single
- Occupation: University student
- Income: Limited, relies on part-time work and parental giving.
- Hobbies: Social media, photography, exploring new places, meeting friends
- Travel Style: Budget-conscious, enjoys short, well-planned trips with friends or solo.

- Role in the Organization:

Eric is a student, he often plans budget trips with friends during school breaks. So, he looks for affordable travel options that maximize his limited budget and time.

- Goals:

Finding inexpensive, convenient travel experiences that fit into his student budget and schedule.

- Challenges and Pain Points:

Eric faces financial constraints, making it difficult to afford high-end trips. He is also time-limited due to his studies, so he needs to find well-curated travel guides that help him plan efficiently without wasting time searching multiple sources.

Persona 2: Amy, the Family Vacation Planner

- Demographics:

- Age: 39

- Marital Status: Married
 - Children: Two (aged 6 and 10)
 - Occupation: Marketing Manager
 - Household Income: \$90,000 annually
 - Hobbies: Family activities, reading, enjoying nature
 - Travel Style: Family-oriented, seeks safe, convenient, and child-friendly destinations
- Role in the Organization:
- Amy is responsible for researching and booking trips that are safe and enjoyable for her whole family. She often looks for destinations that provide a balance between kid-friendly activities and downtime for the parents.
- Goals:
- Planning vacations that keep her children entertained while also offering opportunities for family bonding. She needs destinations that are convenient and safe, with plenty of activities that suit her children's age range.
- Challenges and Pain Points:
- Finding vacation spots that cater to both children and adults without being too expensive. So she needs a website that offers quick, reliable recommendations that save her hours of research.

They both require an easy-to-use website that quickly provides family-friendly attraction recommendations. These two personas guided my design process, ensuring the website was both content-rich and simple to navigate for different types of users.

After finalizing the content for each page, I began sketching the layout to ensure the structure and organization of each page aligned with user needs. Once the sketches were complete, I considered the color scheme for the site. Since the Earth's primary colors are green and blue, I chose green as the background color and blue for the text. Green symbolizes nature, while blue represents the sky and the ocean, further enhancing the theme of global travel.

Finally, I used HTML and CSS to code the website, continuously adjusting and optimizing the layout and design elements to ensure smooth functionality and an aesthetically pleasing experience.

For usability and accessibility principles. First, in terms of usability, I ensured the navigation structure was simple and clear, allowing users to quickly find the information they need. The navigation bar is fixed at the top of each page, featuring key links to "Home," "Destinations," "Landscapes," "Photo Gallery," "Travel Tips," and "Contact Us." Also, under the destinations part I provide 7 continents option which can let user direct choose the continents they want. This consistent design helps users quickly adapt to the website's structure and reduces the time of getting lost. Additionally, I included a search function on the top-right corner, let users to quickly locate specific cities or attractions by typing their names. This feature is especially useful for users with a clear destination in mind. To maintain a seamless user experience, I kept the layout of each continent part consistent, with brief introductions and a grid layout for popular attractions, so users don't have to relearn how to navigate each continents, thus to improv efficiency.

In terms of accessibility, I implemented a responsive design to ensure the website adapts to various screen sizes, such as desktop, tablet, and mobile devices. Additionally, to improve text

readability, I used a light background with dark text to ensure high contrast, which is particularly important for users with visual impairments. This high-contrast design ensures that the website's content remains easy to read under different lighting conditions.

References

Travel Guides & Travel Information. Lonely Planet. (2024, October 4). [https://
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